

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 10: दशमः कः? (Dashamah Kah? - Who Is the Tenth?)

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	10 — दशमः कः? (Dashamah Kah? - Who Is the Tenth?)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Watch the synthesis traps: each boy's count of nine is an OFF-BY-ONE error of self-omission, not a real loss; तीर्त्वा is a गेरुंड/ल्यबन्त (indeclinable 'having crossed'), अगणयत् the लङ्-लकार past of गण् ('count', NOT गा 'sing' → अगायत्); ordinals (दशमः 'tenth') agree in case-gender-number while cardinals (दश 'ten') need not; कतमः = which-of-MANY, कतरः = which-of-TWO; द्वितीयाविभक्ति marks the crossed-object (नदीम्) while the gerund's logical subject stays the sentence subject; and 'दशमः त्वम् असि' is तत्त्वमसि, not a queue position. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A boy in the parable says: 'I counted नव; therefore one of us is मरः.' His reasoning fails at exactly one step. Which?

- (A) His count of नव is right, but 'drowned' should have been 'asleep'.
- (B) His count of नव is right, but the conclusion should be 'all ten are safe'.
- (C) His count of नव is itself wrong — he omitted himself, so 'one is drowned' rests on a false count.
- (D) Both his count and his conclusion are correct; the parable agrees with him.

2. If a tenth, eleventh, ... counter each also forgot only himself, what would each independently report?

- (A) Each would report the true total, because more counters cancel the error.
- (B) Only the first counter ever errs; the rest copy his number.
- (C) Each would report two fewer, because the traveler is also uncounted.
- (D) Each would report one fewer than the true total — the same self-omission error, scaled to any group size.

3. Why does the SAME group yield 'ten' from one counter and 'nine' from another within the parable's logic?

- (A) Whoever counts leaves himself out, so the count depends on WHO counts, not on how many are actually present.
- (B) Because boys keep entering and leaving the river between counts.
- (C) Because some boys can count higher than others.
- (D) Because the river's current sweeps a boy away and back.

4. The boys recount several times and keep getting नव. What does the repetition prove about their error?

- (A) It is systematic, not a slip — repeating the same vantage reproduces the same self-omission every time.
- (B) It proves the count of नव is correct, since it is consistent.
- (C) It proves a different boy drowns on each recount.
- (D) It proves the river is miscounting them, not the boys.

5. Which single change to their PROCEDURE would have let any boy reach the correct total without a पथिकः?

- (A) Counting the boys twice and averaging the two results.
- (B) Counting only the boys still standing in the river.
- (C) Asking the slowest boy to count, since he is careful.
- (D) Each counter adding 'and myself' (एकम् आत्मानम्) at the end of his count.

6. The story's tension is 'दश आगताः, नव दृश्यन्ते' (ten came, nine are seen). The resolution shows the gap is:

- (A) ontic — a boy is genuinely gone and is later rescued.
- (B) ontic — the tenth never existed; only nine ever crossed.
- (C) epistemic — the boys forgot the river's name, not a person.
- (D) epistemic — a counting blind spot — not ontic; no boy is actually absent.

7. Which statement is the MOST precise description of the boys' mistake?

- (A) Each counts every member of the set except the one element that is the counter, so the counter is excluded from his own count.
- (B) They cannot count higher than nine because their language stops there.
- (C) They count the same boy twice and so reach a wrong total.
- (D) They include the traveler too early and so miscount.

8. A modern friend says the boys should have 'taken attendance by name list.' Why does this also fix it, in the parable's terms?

- (A) A name list is an external, fixed reference that includes the counter as a named item, so it does not depend on who is reading it.
- (B) It would not fix it; a list can also forget to list the counter.

- (C) It fixes it only because lists can count past nine.
- (D) It fixes it by removing the slowest boy from the group.

9. When the पथिकः counts the boys and reaches दश, the boys are first आश्चर्यचकिताः. Why surprise rather than relief?

- (A) Because the traveler counted in a foreign language they did not know.
- (B) Their own repeated count said नव, so a credible दश contradicts what they were certain of — surprise precedes the relief.
- (C) Because they had already found the tenth boy themselves.
- (D) Because the traveler refused to tell them the number.

10. The पथिकः points at one boy and says 'दशमः त्वम् असि.' What does the word त्वम् accomplish that merely saying दश would not?

- (A) It tells the boys the traveler is the tenth member.
- (B) It locates the missing tenth in the listener himself, turning a number into a personal discovery.
- (C) It commands the boy to go and find the tenth.
- (D) It asks the boy which of two banks he stood on.

11. Why is the पथिकः, and not the cleverest boy, the one who must reveal the tenth?

- (A) Because the cleverest boy is the one who actually drowned.
- (B) Because travelers always know the road and so can count better.
- (C) Because the boys had taken a vow of silence and could not count aloud.
- (D) Only someone OUTSIDE the counted set can include all of its members; the cleverest insider still cannot count himself.

12. 'दशमः त्वम् असि' read as ordinary arithmetic versus as teaching differ in that the arithmetic reading stops at:

- (A) naming the river, while the teaching reading names the boy.
- (B) the traveler, while the teaching reading blames the boys.
- (C) supplying the missing count ($9 + 1 = 10$), while the teaching reading turns the +1 into the seeker himself.
- (D) the future tense, while the teaching reading uses the past.

13. Suppose the पथिकः had instead said 'नवमः मग्नः न' ('the ninth is not drowned'). Why is this weaker than 'दशमः त्वम् असि'?

- (A) It denies a drowning but never locates the uncounted self, so the boys could still miscount on the next try.
- (B) It is stronger, because it names the exact boy who was thought lost.
- (C) It is identical in force; only the ordinal differs.
- (D) It is weaker only because नवमः is the wrong ordinal for a tenth boy.

14. The पथिकः's role in the parable is best classed as that of:

- (A) a rescuer who physically pulls a drowning boy from the water.
- (B) a judge who punishes the boys for miscounting.
- (C) a गुरु-figure who removes ignorance by redirecting the seeker's attention to himself.
- (D) a king who orders a new census of the village.

15. तत्त्वमसि splits as तत् + त्वम् + असि. In the parable's analogy, तत् ('That') corresponds to:

- (A) the long-sought 'tenth' — the very thing being looked for.
- (B) the river that had to be crossed.
- (C) the traveler who did the counting.
- (D) the act of counting itself.

16. Why does the parable insist the tenth was 'never truly lost,' even while the boys grieved as if he were?

- (A) He had swum to a hidden bank and returned only at the end.
- (B) He was present and active the whole time as the one doing the counting; only his self-awareness was absent.
- (C) A different boy stood in for him until he reappeared.
- (D) He was lost but the traveler created a new tenth to replace him.

17. Which pairing best captures the parable's two-level structure?

- (A) surface: a swimming race; depth: the fastest swimmer wins salvation.
- (B) surface: a flood disaster; depth: rivers must be respected.
- (C) surface: a market dispute; depth: honest trade brings joy.
- (D) surface: a counting puzzle solved by an outsider; depth: the Self is the seeker it seeks.

18. A student says, 'The lesson is just: always double-check your counting.' What does this miss?

- (A) Nothing — careful counting is the entire and only lesson.
- (B) Only that the river was dangerous and should be avoided.
- (C) That the error is built into counting from inside oneself, and the deeper teaching that the sought Self is the seeker.
- (D) Only the name of the village where the boys lived.

19. How does 'each boy forgot himself' map onto the Vedantic claim that we overlook the Self?

- (A) It maps onto forgetting other people's names in a crowd.
- (B) It maps onto losing count of coins while trading.
- (C) Just as the counter omits the one nearest to him (himself), a person overlooks the Self that is nearest of all.
- (D) It does not map; the parable is only about arithmetic.

20. Putting the chapter together, the BEST one-line statement of its theme is:

- (A) careful arithmetic prevents needless grief.
- (B) outsiders always know more than insiders.
- (C) what you seek as the missing 'tenth' is none other than yourself, the one doing the seeking.
- (D) rivers should be crossed only in groups of ten.

21. Counting the boys as प्रथमः, द्वितीयः, ..., the LAST boy and the TOTAL number of boys are named by:

- (A) a cardinal (दश) for the last boy and an ordinal (दशमः) for the total.
- (B) the same word दशमः for both.
- (C) the same word दश for both.
- (D) an ordinal (दशमः) for the last boy and a cardinal (दश) for the total.

22. दशमः बालकः agrees with बालकः in gender, number, and case. So 'the tenth girl' (बालिका, feminine) would be:

- (A) दशमः बालिका — the ordinal stays masculine regardless of the noun.
- (B) दश बालिका — one uses the cardinal for females.
- (C) दशमम् बालिका — the ordinal takes the neuter ending.
- (D) दशमी बालिका — the ordinal takes feminine -ई to agree.

23. Which sequence is correctly ordered low-to-high in ORDINALS?

- (A) एकम्, त्रीणि, पञ्च, सप्त, नव
- (B) प्रथमः, तृतीयः, पञ्चमः, सप्तमः, नवमः
- (C) प्रथमः, द्वितीयः, चतुर्थः, तृतीयः, पञ्चमः
- (D) नवमः, सप्तमः, पञ्चमः, तृतीयः, प्रथमः

24. The cardinal दश ('ten') used as a plain number need not change for the gender of what it counts, but दशमः ('tenth') must. This shows that:

- (A) ordinals never change, but cardinals always agree in gender.
- (B) both always agree in gender, number, and case.
- (C) cardinals (here) behave more like fixed counts while ordinals behave like agreeing adjectives.
- (D) neither ever changes form in Sanskrit.

25. If the boys lined up and the पथिकः said 'अयं नवमः, त्वं तु दशमः,' what is the relation between the two boys named?

- (A) They are the same boy described twice.
- (B) They are first and last with eight boys between unnamed.
- (C) They are adjacent in the sequence: the तु marks a contrast, ninth versus the very next, tenth.
- (D) नवमः means 'new' here, so it is an age comparison.

26. The boys keep asking 'दशमः कः?' Grammatically, दशमः and कः in this question are:

- (A) दशमः nominative but कः accusative, asking whom the tenth saw.
- (B) both accusative, asking about an object of an action.

(C) both masculine nominative singular, so कः asks the identity of the same person दशमः names.

(D) दशमः a verb and कः its subject.

27. To say 'this is the FIRST time the boys crossed,' the needed word is the ordinal:

(A) एकम् (one)

(B) प्रथमम् (first / for the first time)

(C) दशमम् (tenth)

(D) प्रथमः used unchanged, ignoring the neuter sense

28. Each boy's count and the true count differ by one. In ordinal terms, the boy each counter fails to reach is always the:

(A) highest ordinal in his own counting — because he stops one short by leaving himself out.

(B) प्रथमः, the first, whom everyone skips. (C) मध्यमः, the middle one, lost in the crowd.

(D) a randomly different ordinal each time.

29. In नदीं तीर्त्वा, the case of नदीम् is accusative. Why accusative and not nominative नदी?

(A) Because नदीम् is the subject doing the crossing.

(B) Because gerunds always force their noun into the dative.

(C) Because rivers are grammatically always accusative in Sanskrit.

(D) नदीम् is the object crossed by the gerund's action (तीर्त्वा takes a कर्म in द्वितीया).

30. In 'बालकाः नदीं तीर्त्वा पारं गताः,' who is the doer of BOTH तीर्त्वा and गताः?

(A) the river does the crossing, the boys do the going.

(B) the gerund has its own separate doer, unnamed.

(C) the bank (पारम्) is the doer of गताः.

(D) the boys (बालकाः) — a gerund shares the main clause's subject.

31. तीर्त्वा and गत्वा are both gerunds. In 'नदीं तीर्त्वा वनं गत्वा फलानि अखादन्,' the order of events is:

(A) eat fruits, then cross, then go — the finite verb comes first in time.

(B) first cross the river, then go to the forest, then eat fruits — gerunds mark prior, completed actions in sequence.

(C) all three happen at the same instant.

(D) go to the forest, then cross the river, then eat.

32. Which sentence uses तीर्त्वा CORRECTLY?

(A) सः तीर्त्वा अस्ति। (He is having-crossed.)

(B) तीर्त्वा नदीम् अतरत्। (Having-crossed crossed the river.)

(C) सः नदीं तीर्त्वा गृहम् अगच्छत्। (Having crossed the river, he went home.)

(D) सः नदीं तीर्त्वाति। (He having-crosses the river.)

33. तीर्त्वा is built on the root तृ ('cross/swim across'). The matching finite past 'they crossed' would be:

(A) अगायन् (they sang)

(B) अतरन् (they crossed)

(C) अगणयन् (they counted)

(D) अमज्जन् (they sank)

34. Why is तीर्त्वा called 'indeclinable,' unlike गताः in the same sentence?

(A) तीर्त्वा changes for tense, but गताः does not.

(B) Both are indeclinable; the claim is just a label.

(C) तीर्त्वा never changes its form for number/gender/case, while गताः (a participle) is plural-masculine-nominative and would change.

(D) तीर्त्वा declines for gender, गताः for tense.

35. A student writes 'नदीम् तरन् पारं गताः' meaning 'having crossed the river they reached the bank.' What is wrong?

(A) तरन् is a present participle ('while crossing'), not the gerund तीर्त्वा ('having crossed'); the completed-prior sense is lost.

(B) Nothing — तरन् and तीर्त्वा mean exactly the same.

(C) नदीम् should be nominative नदी as the doer.

(D) गताः should be singular गतः to match तरन्.

36. अगणयत् splits as अ + गणय + त्. What does the prefixed अ- (the augment) signal?

(A) negation — 'he did NOT count.'

(B) past time — the अ-augment (आगम) marks the लङ्-लकार (imperfect past).

(C) the future tense.

(D) a command — 'let him count.'

37. If अगणयत् is 'he counted,' the corresponding 'they counted' (third person plural, same tense) is:

(A) अगणयन्

(B) अगणयत् (unchanged for plural)

(C) गणयिष्यन्ति (they will count)

(D) अगायन् (they sang)

38. Which transformation is INTERNALLY consistent (same root, present→past)?

(A) गणयति (he counts) → अगणयत् (he counted) (B) गणयति (he counts) → अगायत् (he sang)

(C) गायति (he sings) → अगणयत् (he counted) (D) तरति (he crosses) → अमज्जत् (he sank)

39. The boys feared a boy was मग्नः (drowned). The finite verb 'he sank/drowned,' built on the same idea, would be:

(A) अगणयत् (he counted)

(B) अमज्जत् (he sank), from मस्ज्

(C) अतरत् (he crossed)

(D) अगायत् (he sang)

40. A boy says he 'sang' the count aloud. Which single Devanagari letter change turns 'he sang' into 'he counted'?

(A) Add an अ- prefix; both already differ only by negation.

(B) Replace the य of अगायत् with णय → अगणयत् (the root changes from गा to गण).

(C) Change the final त् to नृ; tense letter alone differs.

(D) No change is possible; the words are unrelated suppletive forms.

41. Match the four parable-actions to roots: cross / sing / count / drown. The correct set of roots is:

(A) तृ / गा / गण् / मस्ज्

(B) गण् / गा / तृ / मस्ज्

(C) तृ / गण् / गा / ज्ञा

(D) मस्ज् / गा / गण् / तृ

42. A student parses अगणयत् as 'present, he counts.' Two things are wrong if it were present. Which correctly states them?

(A) Present would add the अ-augment and end in -ति; the present is अगणयति.

(B) Present would be अगणयन्, the plural. (C) Nothing is wrong; अगणयत् is indeed present.

(D) Present would have no अ-augment and would end without the past -त् pattern; the present is गणयति.

43. Choosing 'which of the TEN boys is the tenth?', the precise interrogative AND its reason are:

(A) कतरः, because we choose one definite boy.

(B) कः, because any 'who' word works for people.

(C) किम्, because we ask about a thing.

(D) कतमः, because the choice is among many (more than two).

44. A fork in the road offers exactly two paths. 'By which path did the traveler come?' uses:

(A) कतरेण पथा — कतर- (which of two) in the instrumental.

(B) कतमेन पथा — कतम- (which of many).

(C) केन पथा — plain 'by which', losing the two-way sense.

(D) कतिभिः पथा — 'by how many paths.'

45. Order these interrogatives by what they ask: कति, कदा, कतरः, कतमः.

(A) which of two / which of many / how many / when

(B) how many / when / which of two / which of many

(C) when / how many / which of many / which of two

(D) who / what / which of two / which of many

46. Why would 'कतरः मग्नः?' be the WRONG question for the boys to ask about ten boys?

(A) कतरः asks 'which of two,' but there are ten boys, so कतमः is needed.

(B) कतरः means 'who drowned,' which assumes someone drowned.

(C) कतरः is a future-tense verb, not a question word.

(D) कतरः asks 'how many drowned,' the wrong quantity word.

47. If the boys narrowed it to just two suspects for 'the missing one,' the right question becomes:

(A) एषां कतमः मग्नः? (which of these many drowned?)

(B) अनयोः कतरः मग्नः? (which of these two drowned?)

(C) कति मग्नाः? (how many drowned?)

(D) कः मग्नः कदा? (who drowned, and when?)

48. The chapter's interrogatives कतमः and कतरः differ ONLY in the size of the choice-set. Which other pair differs the same way (set-size), not in meaning-type?

- (A) कः (who) vs किम् (what) — they differ only in set size.
- (B) कदा (when) vs कुत्र (where) — they differ only in set size.
- (C) Neither कः/किम् nor कदा/कुत्र — those differ in WHAT is asked, not set size.
- (D) कति (how many) vs कदा (when) — they differ only in set size.

49. पथिकः is analysed as पथ् ('road/path') + -इकः. The suffix -इकः here makes a word meaning:

- (A) 'a small road' — a diminutive of path.
- (B) 'one connected with / who travels the road' — a traveller.
- (C) 'the act of road-building.'
- (D) 'without a road' — a negative.

50. 'दशमः कः?' has no written verb. Which finite verb is correctly understood, and in which person/number?

- (A) असि ('are'), second person, because the traveller addresses 'you'.
- (B) सन्ति ('are'), third person plural, because there are ten boys.
- (C) अभवत् ('was'), past tense, because the crossing already happened.
- (D) अस्ति ('is'), third person singular, agreeing with the singular subject दशमः/कः.

51. In 'बालकाः विषण्णाः अभवन्', the word विषण्णाः agrees with बालकाः in being:

- (A) accusative plural — the object of अभवन्.
- (B) singular — describing one sad boy only.
- (C) feminine — because sadness is grammatically feminine.
- (D) masculine nominative plural — a participle/adjective agreeing with the plural subject 'boys'.

52. The boys' state-change is told as 'विषण्णाः ... ततः प्रहृष्टाः अभवन्'. The connector ततः signals:

- (A) sequence — 'thereafter / then' — the joy follows the sadness in time.
- (B) cause from the joy — 'because they were delighted'.
- (C) place — 'from there', a location they left.
- (D) negation — 'they were not delighted'.

53. The boys' mood shifts विषण्णाः → प्रहृष्टाः. Choose the pair that shows the SAME kind of shift (negative → positive emotion):

- (A) प्रहृष्टाः → विषण्णाः (delighted → sad)
- (B) श्रान्ताः → क्लान्ताः (tired → weary)
- (C) दुःखिताः → सन्तुष्टाः (sorrowful → contented)
- (D) विस्मिताः → आश्चर्यचकिताः (surprised → astonished)

54. In the parable, हर्ष (joy at finding the tenth) is the boys' FINAL state, while विस्मय (wonder/surprise) is:

- (A) the same as हर्ष, just a synonym.
- (B) their starting state before any counting.
- (C) an intermediate reaction — the shock that the count was ten, felt before the joy settles.
- (D) the cause of the drowning they feared.

55. नदीम् + तीर्त्वा is written नदीं तीर्त्वा. The anusvāra (ँ) on नदीं stands for:

- (A) a long ā vowel added to नदी.
- (B) the म् of नदीम् before the following consonant त्.
- (C) a dropped letter that means nothing. (D) the gerund ending fused into the noun.

56. Which word-meaning set is ENTIRELY correct?

- (A) पथिकः = road; अगणयत् = he counted; मग्नः = drowned; प्रहृष्टः = sad
- (B) पथिकः = traveller; अगणयत् = he sang; मग्नः = drowned; प्रहृष्टः = delighted
- (C) पथिकः = traveller; अगणयत् = he counted; मग्नः = delighted; प्रहृष्टः = drowned
- (D) पथिकः = traveller; अगणयत् = he counted; मग्नः = drowned; प्रहृष्टः = delighted

57. Which grammar set is ENTIRELY correct?

- (A) तीर्त्वा = gerund (indeclinable); अगणयत् = imperfect past; नदीम् = accusative object; दशमः = ordinal
- (B) तीर्त्वा = future verb; अगणयत् = imperfect past; नदीम् = nominative subject; दशमः = ordinal
- (C) तीर्त्वा = gerund; अगणयत् = present; नदीम् = accusative; दशमः = cardinal
- (D) तीर्त्वा = gerund; अगणयत् = imperfect past; नदीम् = dative; दशमः = ordinal

58. A student summarises: 'The boys lost a friend in the river; a kind traveller dived in and saved him.' What is the ROOT error?

- (A) Only the detail that it was the river, not a lake.
- (B) Only that the traveller walked rather than dived.
- (C) No one was ever lost — the 'tenth' was the uncounted self; the traveller revealed, he did not rescue.
- (D) Nothing — that is an accurate retelling.

59. Which statement chains the chapter's grammar AND meaning correctly?

- (A) तीर्त्वा (will cross) sets the future, then each boy अगणयत् (sang) नव songs, and the tenth truly drowned.
- (B) After तीर्त्वा (crossing), each boy अगणयत् (counted) and found दश, so there was never any worry.
- (C) तीर्त्वा (having crossed), each boy अगणयत् (counted) नव, and the traveller himself was the missing tenth.
- (D) तीर्त्वा (having crossed) sets the scene, then each boy अगणयत् (counted) and found नव, until the पथिकः showed दशमः त्वम् असि — the Self was never lost.

60. Across the chapter, the link between the GRAMMAR lessons and the PARABLE is best stated as:

- (A) the grammar is unrelated padding attached to an unrelated story.
- (B) the grammar tools (ordinals to place the tenth, the gerund to sequence crossing-then-counting, the past tense to narrate, कतमः to ask which-of-many) are the very means of telling and probing the Self-parable.

(C) the parable teaches grammar rules and has no metaphysical point.

(D) the grammar proves that ten boys really lost one in the river.

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 10: दशमः कः? (Dashamah Kah? - Who Is the Tenth?) — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	D	21	D	31	B	41	A	51	D
2	D	12	C	22	D	32	C	42	D	52	A
3	A	13	A	23	B	33	B	43	D	53	C
4	A	14	C	24	C	34	C	44	A	54	C
5	D	15	A	25	C	35	A	45	B	55	B
6	D	16	B	26	C	36	B	46	A	56	D
7	A	17	D	27	B	37	A	47	B	57	A
8	A	18	C	28	A	38	A	48	C	58	C
9	B	19	C	29	D	39	B	49	B	59	D
10	B	20	C	30	D	40	B	50	D	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) The arithmetic 'nine present, ten started, so one lost' is valid IF the count of nine were true. It is not: each counter skips himself, so the real present total is ten and the count should read दश. The break is in the premise (the miscount), not in the inference or in the meaning of मरः. So the chain is sound logic on a false fact. The 'asleep' swap is wrong (मरः = drowned); 'all safe' is the true situation but is not where HIS reasoning breaks; and agreeing with him ignores the self-omission the whole story turns on.

2. (D) The error is structural: a counter cannot include himself in his own count, so he always lands one short of the true total, whatever the size. More counters do not cancel it — each repeats it. They are not copying one another; each independently undercounts by exactly one (not two — the पथिकः stands outside the group and is not part of 'the boys' being counted). This generalises the off-by-one self-omission beyond the specific number ten.

3. (A) An outside counter (the पथिकः) includes all ten and gets ten; any boy counting from inside the group excludes himself and gets nine. The total present never changes — boys do not come and go, and none is swept away (no one actually drowned). It is not a skill gap in counting. The variable is the counter's vantage point: a self-excluding insider versus an all-including outsider.

4. (A) Consistency of a wrong answer signals a systematic flaw, not accuracy. Each recount is done the same way — a boy counting the others while skipping himself — so it reproduces the off-by-one error identically. No new boy drowns each time (nobody drowned at all), and rivers do not count. Reliability of a method does not make it valid; here the repeated नव is the fingerprint of the same self-forgetting.

5. (D) The fix targets the exact flaw: include the omitted self by adding one for the counter. Averaging two undercounts of nine still yields nine. Counting only those in the river loses even more boys (those on the bank). Care or speed is irrelevant — even the most careful boy structurally cannot count himself unless the procedure tells him to add himself. Only 'न' + adding oneself repairs the off-by-one.

6. (D) Ten truly crossed (Q on Paper-1 fixes the number at ten) and ten are truly present; the 'missing' one is missing only from each boy's awareness — a blind spot, hence epistemic, not a real (ontic) absence. No rescue occurs because no one is lost. The tenth did exist and did cross. The gap is between knowing and being, which is precisely why a mere shift in viewpoint (the पथिकः) dissolves it.

7. (A) The defect is exclusion of exactly one element — the counting subject himself — from the counted set, every time. Sanskrit numerals plainly go past nine (दश, एकादश...), so it is no linguistic ceiling. They do not double-count anyone, and the पथिकः is outside the group, not wrongly included. Precise wording matters at olympiad level: it is self-exclusion, not over-counting or a vocabulary limit.

8. (A) The whole point is that a fixed external reference (a name list, or the outside पथिकः) counts all ten regardless of who reads it, because the reader's own name is already on it — the self is not omitted. A correctly made list includes everyone by definition. It is not about counting past nine (they can) nor about removing anyone. This mirrors why the पथिकः, an outside reference, succeeds where each insider fails.

9. (B) Surprise (आश्चर्य/विस्मय) is the natural first response when a trusted result (their नव) is overturned by an authority's दश; relief/joy (हर्ष, प्रहृष्टः) follows once they grasp it. The traveler does count and does communicate the number, in terms they understand. They had NOT found the tenth themselves — that is exactly what they were failing to do. The emotional sequence is surprise → joy, matching विस्मय preceding हर्ष.

10. (B) 'दश' alone gives only a total; 'त्वम्' (you) pins the uncounted one onto the very person who kept missing him — himself. The traveler is not naming himself the tenth (he

is outside the group). असि is the verb 'are' (a statement), not a command (that would be भव) nor a question. There is no two-bank choice. The pronoun is the hinge that converts arithmetic into self-recognition — the seed of the Vedantic reading.

11. (D) The flaw is positional, not intellectual: any member counting from inside omits himself no matter how clever. Standing outside, the पथिकः includes every boy. No boy drowned, so 'the cleverest drowned' is false; knowing the road has nothing to do with set-counting; and the boys were plainly counting aloud, not silent. The outsider's vantage — not extra cleverness — is decisive.

12. (C) Arithmetically the line just restores the missing unit: nine seen plus the overlooked self makes ten. The teaching reading takes that overlooked self and identifies it with the very one who was searching — hence तत्त्वमसि. Both readings agree on the number; they differ on what the +1 MEANS. The line names no river, असि is present tense throughout, and the point is recognition, not blame.

13. (A) Saying 'no one drowned' removes the false alarm but leaves the procedural error intact — they would undercount again, because the self-omission is untouched. 'दशमः त्वम् असि' fixes the cause by pointing to the omitted self. It is not stronger or identical: it lacks the crucial 'you'. The weakness is conceptual (it never addresses the blind spot), not just a matter of choosing नवमः vs दशमः.

14. (C) He gives no new boy and performs no rescue (none drowned); he imposes no punishment and orders no census. What he does is dispel a misconception by turning the boys' gaze onto the overlooked self — the classic teacher's act in the Vedantic frame. Hence गुरु-figure, not rescuer, judge, or king.

15. (A) In तत्त्वमसि, तत् is 'That' (the sought reality / Self), त्वम् 'you', असि 'are' — 'That you are.' Mapping onto the parable, 'That (the tenth being sought)' is identified with 'you (the seeker).' The river is the obstacle crossed, not the goal; the traveler is the teacher who reveals, not the sought; counting is the activity, not the object. So तत् ↔ the tenth, and त्वम् ↔ the boy who is it.

16. (B) The tenth is each counter himself — fully present, in fact the most active member (he is counting!). What was missing was his inclusion of himself in his own awareness, not his body. He did not hide and return, no substitute stood in, and no new boy was created. The grief was over an illusion: the loss was only in the counting, never in reality — the heart of the 'Self present all along' reading.

17. (D) On the surface it is a number puzzle resolved by an outside viewpoint; underneath, the 'tenth' the boys hunt for is themselves — the Self is identical with the seeker (तत्त्वमसि). It is not a race, a flood-safety tale, or a market story; those belong to other chapters. The two levels — arithmetic and metaphysical — are bound by the single image of the overlooked self.

18. (C) 'Double-check' is good advice but misses two things: (1) the error is structural self-omission, which more checks of the same kind reproduce, and (2) the chapter's whole point is the Self/seeker identity (तत्त्वमसि). It is not the WHOLE lesson; the river's danger and the village name are incidental and never the teaching. The metaphysical layer is what elevates this above a counting tip.

19. (C) The analogy is exact: the one thing a counter cannot see is the counter — the nearest item of all — mirroring how the Self, being the very subject, is overlooked while one searches outward. It is not about forgetting others' names or miscounting coins, and the parable is explicitly framed (तत्त्वमसि) to carry this metaphysical mapping. Nearness causing oversight is the shared structure.

20. (C) The chapter binds the parable to तत्त्वमसि: the sought tenth is the seeker. Careful arithmetic and outsider-wisdom are surface morals at best (and outsiders aren't always wiser — the पथिकः wins only by vantage, not knowledge). The group-of-ten line is a literal misreading. Only the Self-is-the-seeker statement names the chapter's actual theme.

21. (D) Position in a sequence is ordinal: the last boy is the दशमः ('tenth'). A bare count of how many there are is cardinal: दश ('ten'). The two roles are distinct, so neither word does both jobs, and they are not swapped (the last one is 'tenth', the total is 'ten'). This is the cardinal/ordinal division applied to the parable's own headcount.

22. (D) Ordinals are adjectives and agree with their noun; the masculine दशमः has the feminine दशमी (-ई stem). With बालिका (feminine), agreement gives दशमी बालिका. It does not stay masculine (दशमः), one does not switch to the cardinal दश for females, and बालिका is feminine not neuter, so दशमम् is wrong. Self-verified: ordinal adjectives inflect for gender, hence दशमी.

23. (B) The ordinals 'first, third, fifth, seventh, ninth' are प्रथमः, तृतीयः, पञ्चमः, सप्तमः, नवमः — correctly increasing. The एकम्/त्रीणि/... list is cardinals, not ordinals. The list with द्वितीयः then चतुर्थः then तृतीयः is out of order (fourth before third). The last list is high-to-low, not low-to-high. Only the first is both all-ordinal and ascending.

24. (C) दशमः → दशमी for a feminine noun shows the ordinal agreeing like an adjective; the plain count 'ten' does not track the counted noun's gender the same way. So the contrast is exactly the reverse of 'ordinals never change, cardinals always agree.' They are not both fully agreeing, and Sanskrit words certainly do inflect. The parable's headcount (दश boys) vs ordinal place (दशमः boy) illustrates this.

25. (C) नवमः = ninth, दशमः = tenth — consecutive positions; तु ('but/whereas') simply contrasts the two. They are different boys (ninth ≠ tenth), and they are adjacent, not first-and-last. नवमः ('ninth', ordinal of नव) must not be confused with नव(-ीन) 'new'; this is an ordinal, not an age word. So: neighbours in line.

26. (C) 'दशमः कः?' = 'The tenth — who (is he)?' Both words are masculine nominative singular and refer to the same individual; कः seeks his identity, with असि/अस्ति understood. कः is not accusative (that would be कम्), neither word is accusative here, and दशमः is an ordinal adjective/substantive, not a verb. Agreement of दशमः and कः in nominative is what makes them co-refer.

27. (B) 'For the first time' uses the ordinal प्रथमः, here in the adverbial/neuter form प्रथमम्. एकम् is the cardinal 'one', not 'first'. दशमम् is 'tenth', the wrong rank. And one cannot keep प्रथमः unchanged when an adverbial neuter प्रथमम् is required — ordinals inflect. So प्रथमम् is right; the trap is cardinal-for-ordinal and frozen-form errors.

28. (A) A counter enumerates the others and stops; the unreached position is the one his own self would have occupied — effectively the top of the count, leaving him at nine and the true tenth (himself) unreached. It is not the first (he can see the first) nor the middle, and it is not random — it is systematically the self, the omitted top. This ties the off-by-one directly to the highest ordinal दशमः.

29. (D) तृ ('cross') is transitive; what is crossed — the river — is its कर्म (object), so it takes द्वितीया (accusative): नदीम्. The subject is the boys (who 'went', गताः), not the river. Gerunds do not force dative, and there is no rule making 'river' inherently accusative — it is accusative here only because it is the object of crossing. Self-verified: object of तीर्त्वा → accusative नदीम्.

30. (D) A Sanskrit gerund (ल्यबन्त like तीर्त्वा) shares its subject with the finite verb of the sentence. Here both the crossing and the going are done by the boys (बालकाः, nominative plural). The river is the object crossed, not a doer; the gerund has no independent doer; and पारम् ('to the far bank') is accusative goal, not the subject. So one subject — the boys — performs both actions.

31. (B) Each gerund denotes an action completed before the next; the finite verb (अखादन्, 'they ate') is last in time. So the sequence follows the surface order: तीर्त्वा (crossed) → गत्वा (went) → अखादन् (ate). The finite verb is not first in time; the actions are sequential, not simultaneous; and the order is cross-then-go (river before forest), as written. Gerund chaining = ordered prior actions.

32. (C) तीर्त्वा is an indeclinable gerund pairing with a finite verb: 'crossed the river, (then) went home' — correct. It cannot be the predicate of अस्ति ('is') as if a participle of state. Pairing तीर्त्वा with अतरत् ('crossed') is redundant and ill-formed (the gerund and finite verb name the same crossing). तीर्वति is not a word — तीर्त्वा does not conjugate (it is indeclinable). Only the first is well-formed.

33. (B) तीर्त्वा is the gerund of तृ; its लङ्-लकार third-person plural is अतरन् ('they crossed'). अगायन् is from गा ('sing'), अगणयन् from गण् ('count'), and अमज्जन् from मस्ज् ('sink/drown', the

verb behind मग्नः). Only अतरन् shares the root तृ with तीर्त्वा. This keeps the four key parable-roots — cross, sing, count, drown — apart.

34. (C) The gerund (अव्यय/ल्यबन्त) तीर्त्वा is fixed in form regardless of who crosses or how many. गताः, a past participle, agrees as masculine nominative plural and would shift (e.g. गता for a feminine subject). तीर्त्वा does not change for tense either (it has no finite tense). गताः is not indeclinable. So तीर्त्वा = unchanging, गताः = agreeing — the defining contrast.

35. (A) तरन् is the present (शतृ) participle 'crossing/while crossing'; it does not convey the completed-before sense that तीर्त्वा ('having crossed') gives. नदीम् is correctly accusative (object crossed), not the subject. गताः is correctly plural for 'they.' The genuine fault is using a simultaneous present participle where a prior-action gerund is meant — exactly the तीर्त्वा vs तरन् distinction.

36. (B) The initial अ- here is the augment (अडागम) prefixed to past-tense (लङ्/लुङ्/लृङ्) forms; in अगणयत् it marks लङ्-लकार, 'he counted.' It is NOT the negating अ- of compounds (that would not carry the past-tense ending -त्). The future would be गणयिष्यति; a command (लोट्) would be गणयतु. So अ- = past augment, giving 'he counted.'

37. (A) लङ्-लकार third-person: singular अगणयत्, plural अगणयन्. The form does change for number, so अगणयत् cannot serve as plural. गणयिष्यति is future ('will count'), not past. अगायन् is from गा ('sing'). Self-verified: 'they counted' = अगणयन्, the plural of अगणयत्.

38. (A) गण् gives present गणयति and past अगणयत् — same root, correct tense shift. गणयति → अगायत् switches to root गा (sing). गायति → अगणयत् likewise mismatches sing-present with count-past. तरति → अमज्जत् switches तृ (cross) to मस्ज् (sink). Only गणयति → अगणयत् keeps one root across the tense change.

39. (B) मग्नः ('drowned/submerged') is the past participle of मस्ज् ('sink'); its लङ्-लकार 'he sank' is अमज्जत्. अगणयत् is from गण् (count), अतरत् from तृ (cross), अगायत् from गा (sing). Only अमज्जत् matches the 'drowned' idea behind मग्नः. The trap is letting the surrounding count/cross/sing roots leak in.

40. (B) अगायत् (गा, sing) and अगणयत् (गण्, count) differ in their root portion: गा-य- versus गण्-अय-. The contrast is in the consonant cluster (य vs णय), reflecting the different roots — exactly the गा-vs-गण् warning of the chapter. Adding अ- does not relate sing to count; changing त्→न् only shifts to plural; and the forms ARE relatable through their distinct roots, not suppletive. Listening for the ण्/count consonant is the chapter's own cue.

41. (A) Cross = तृ (→ तरति, तीर्त्वा), sing = गा (→ गायति), count = गण् (→ गणयति, अगणयत्), drown/sink = मस्ज् (→ मग्नः). The other sets swap cross with count, or count with sing, or substitute ज्ञा (know) / reorder. Only तृ/गा/गण्/मस्ज् pairs each action with its right root — the four roots the chapter deliberately keeps distinct.

42. (D) The present गणयति lacks the अ-augment (which marks past) and ends in -ति; अगणयत् has the augment and the लङ् ending -त्, so it is past, not present. The present does NOT take the augment, so 'अगणयति' is impossible. अगणयन् is the past plural, not the present. So the two markers of pastness — augment अ- and the लङ् ending — both rule out a present reading.

43. (D) Ten is 'many' (more than two), so 'which of many?' = कतमः. कतरः is reserved for a choice between exactly two. कः is the general 'who' but not the precise 'which-of-a-set' word the question calls for. किम् ('what') is for things, not for selecting a boy. The number of options (ten) dictates कतमः.

44. (A) Exactly two paths → 'which of two' = कतरः, here instrumental कतरेण (by which path). कतम- is for many, wrong when there are only two. केन ('by which/what') is the general form and does not encode the two-way restriction the question highlights. कतिभिः asks 'by how many', a different question. So कतरेण पथा is precise for a two-way fork.

45. (B) कति = how many, कदा = when, कतरः = which of two, कतमः = which of many. Matching in the listed order gives 'how many / when / which of two / which of many.' The other orderings misalign at least one pair, and none of the four words means 'who' (कः) or 'what' (किम्). Self-verified term by term.

46. (A) With ten candidates the correct selector is कतमः ('which of many'); कतरः is strictly for a two-way choice, so it is the wrong word for a field of ten. कतरः is not a verb and does not mean 'how many' (that is कति). It does carry the false 'someone drowned' assumption, but the word-level error the question targets is two-vs-many: कतरः vs कतमः.

47. (B) Reduced to two, 'which of two?' = कतरः, with the genitive dual अनयोः ('of these two'). कतमः (which of many) is now too broad. कति asks 'how many', a count not a selection. The 'who...when' form changes the question entirely. So narrowing from many to two flips कतमः → कतरः — the precise contrast the chapter teaches.

48. (C) कतमः/कतरः both ask 'which?' and differ only in how many options exist (many vs two). The other listed pairs differ in CATEGORY of question: कः asks about a person, किम् about a thing; कदा asks time, कुत्र place; कति number, कदा time. None of those is a pure set-size contrast. Hence the correct choice is that NONE of the offered pairs matches — they differ in kind, not in set size.

49. (B) The तद्धित suffix -इक (with -अः for masculine) forms 'one connected with X'; from पथिन् ('road') it yields पथिकः, 'one of the road' = traveller/wayfarer. It is not a diminutive ('small road'), not an action noun ('road-building'), and not a negative ('roadless'). Knowing पथिकः is a common noun built this way (not a proper name) is the chapter's point.

50. (D) 'दशमः कः?' = 'Who is the tenth?'; the elided copula is अस्ति, third-person singular, matching the singular दशमः/कः. असि (2nd person) belongs to the traveller's later direct address 'दशमः त्वम् असि', not to this open question. सन्ति (plural) would need a plural subject;

here the subject is one person. The question is in the narrative present, not past अभवत्.
Self-verified: understood verb = अस्ति (3 sg).

51. (D) विषण्णाः ('dejected') is a predicate adjective/participle qualifying बालकाः ('boys'), so it agrees as masculine nominative plural. It is not accusative — a verb of being (अभवत्, 'became') takes a nominative complement, not an object. It is plural, not singular (all the boys grieve), and it agrees with the masculine बालकाः, not some abstract 'feminine sadness'. Agreement: nominative plural masculine matching the subject.

52. (A) ततः here is the sequencing adverb 'then/thereafter', marking that प्रहृष्टाः (delighted) comes after विषण्णाः (sad) — the emotional turn once the tenth is found. It is not a causal 'because', and while ततः can mean 'from there' (ablative sense of तद्) the narrative use is temporal here. It carries no negation. So ततः = 'then', ordering sad → (discovery) → glad.

53. (C) विषण्णाः (sad) → प्रहृष्टाः (delighted) is a negative-to-positive shift; दुःखिताः → सन्तुष्टाः (sorrowful → contented) matches that direction. प्रहृष्टाः → विषण्णाः is the reverse (positive → negative). श्रान्ताः → क्लान्ताः stays negative (both 'tired'). विस्मिताः → आश्चर्यचकिताः stays within surprise (no relief). Only sorrow → contentment mirrors the parable's emotional arc.

54. (C) On hearing 'दशमः त्वम् असि,' the boys first feel विस्मय (surprise/wonder that nine was wrong), then हर्ष (joy/relief) as the truth lands — so wonder is intermediate, joy final. विस्मय is not a synonym of हर्ष (one is surprise, the other joy). Their starting state was विषण्णाः (sad/grieving), not wonder. And no one actually drowned, so विस्मय causes no drowning. Sequence: sad → surprised → joyful.

55. (B) Before a consonant, a word-final म् may be written as anusvāra: नदीम् → नदीं (then तीर्त्वा). The dot represents the म् sound, not an added long vowel, not a meaningless mark, and not part of the gerund (तीर्त्वा keeps its own form). So नदीं = नदीम् with the म् shown as anusvāra — a spelling/sandhi convention, not a change of word.

56. (D) All four right: पथिकः = traveller (not the road itself), अगणयत् = he counted (गण्, not गा 'sang'), मग्नः = drowned/submerged (not delighted), प्रहृष्टाः = delighted (not sad, not drowned). Each distractor flips exactly one pair (road / sang / mood-swaps), so only the first set is fully correct. This bundles the chapter's key vocabulary traps.

57. (A) All four correct: तीर्त्वा is an indeclinable gerund; अगणयत् is लङ्-लकार (imperfect past); नदीम् is accusative (object of crossing); दशमः is an ordinal ('tenth'). Each distractor breaks one: calling तीर्त्वा a future verb, or अगणयत् present, or नदीम् nominative/dative, or दशमः a cardinal. Only the first keeps every label right — the chapter's full grammar profile.

58. (C) The summary invents a real drowning and a physical rescue, contradicting the parable: the tenth was present all along (each boy's own uncounted self), and the पथिकः reveals the truth ('दशमः त्वम् असि') rather than saving anyone. The error is not a river/lake or walk/dive detail — it is the fabricated loss-and-rescue, which erases the chapter's whole point. So the root error is treating an epistemic gap as a real drowning.

59. (D) Correct chain: gerund तीर्त्वा (completed crossing, past), then अगणयत् (counted, past) yielding नव through self-omission, resolved by 'दशमः त्वम् असि' — the self was present all along. The distractors break it: 'will cross/sang/drowned' mislabels tense, root, and outcome; 'found दश, no worry' erases the miscount that drives the story; and 'the traveller was the tenth' is false — the tenth is each boy himself, the पथिकः stands outside. Only the first is consistent in grammar and meaning.

60. (B) The forms serve the story: दशमः (ordinal) names the sought one, तीर्त्वा (gerund) orders 'crossed then counted', अगणयत् (past) narrates, and कतमः frames 'which of the many?'. So grammar and parable interlock — not unrelated padding, and the story is not merely a grammar drill (it carries तत्त्वमसि). Nothing in the grammar 'proves' a real drowning — none occurred. Tools and tale are one fabric.